SATURDAY
October 24, 2026
DELHI
6 Pages
₹ 6.00

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Vol.149 • No.252

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Can social media bans protect young people's mental health?

The year 2026 has been an expensive one for social media platforms.

Since March, YouTube and Meta, the parent company of Instagram and Facebook, have settled or paid out in multiple lawsuits to the tune of more than US$17 billion for allegedly acting negligently, deliberately designing their platforms to hook kids and misleading the public about safety and privacy. If these suits are any indication of how states and the public are starting to view social media platforms, more may follow.

On top of these lawsuits, social media platforms are facing a loss of business as bans for minors are accelerating and spreading worldwide. Australia was one of the first with a ban on kids under 16 on social media starting in December 2025, followed soon after by the U.K. with a similar prohibition.

The current list of countries looking to ban minors from these platforms tops more than 20, from Greece to the United Arab Emirates to Canada. The proposed and enacted bans around the world vary in terms of age restriction, parental consent rules and age verification methods. Different countries are looking at restricting different platforms, but most include a mix of Snapchat, YouTube, TikTok, Instagram, Facebook and X.

These bans aren't necessarily for mental health reasons only — some are motivated by political concerns about foreign-owned platforms, and others aim to protect young people's privacy. The question is, are these bans the solution to the mental health problems young people are facing?

MENTAL HEALTH CONCERNS

Since Jonathan Haidt's 2024 book *The Anxious Generation* critics of social media have increasingly focused on young people's mental health. Haidt argues that social media disrupts kids' social and neurological development, contributing to rising anxiety and depression through sleep loss, fragmented attention, addiction, loneliness, social comparison and perfectionism. A 2026 study found that young people between 14 and 20 are more than 100% more likely to experience mental illness than 14- to 20-year-olds 50 years ago. Increased use of social media and screen time is compounding an already precarious time for minors. In 2021, it was estimated that 20.5% of young people experienced elevated symptoms of anxiety, and 25.2% of youth reported elevated symptoms of depression globally. Many factors contribute to this, including better screening and awareness of kids' mental health problems, as well as societal disruptions as a result of the COVID-19 pandemic. As the world sheltered in place and moved online for work, school and social interactions, there was an increase in isolation and loneliness.

Is it even possible?

Early evidence from the Australian social media ban shows that kids are finding work-arounds: Roughly 61% of kids ages 12–15 continue to access platforms using false IDs, altered appearances or virtual private networks, or VPNs, even though millions of accounts were disabled. In fact, this has become so common that U.K. lawmakers are debating restricting consumer VPN access.

Some countries, such as Australia, require the platforms themselves to develop ways of verifying a user's age. Some minors have bypassed scans from biometric age estimation technology by using photo manipulation software, substituting celebrity photos, using clever makeup and even utilising older friends and parents to pass the "selfie tests" on their behalf. Others simply manipulate their birth years during registration or rely on existing adult-verified accounts managed by family members.

And all of these age-verification methods, whether developed by a government or a social media platform, rely on collecting sensitive data to estimate age accurately, which creates privacy concerns.

Australia is currently seeking to raise fines on social media platforms that fail to comply with its requirements. The Australian safety commissioner, charged with enforcing the ban, issued a compliance update that showed 7 in 10 children who held accounts in restricted platforms remained on those platforms, and more than 80% of Australian teens ages 10-15 still use social media frequently.

Beyond concerns about enacting and enforcing these restrictions, some policymakers also worry that total bans could push some kids to migrate to even riskier online spaces.

PHOTOS: GETTYIMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO



NOT ALL BAD

In light of these concerns, some researchers argue that bans on social media platforms are like putting an age restriction on buying alcohol or cigarettes. But unlike these addictive and potentially harmful substances, there are benefits to social media, especially for teens who feel disconnected and want to build relationships with others who feel similarly. Social media platforms allow for global connectivity and community-building with like-minded groups. They also provide a place for self-expression and civic engagement.



WHAT COULD WORK

Based on the evidence, I'm not convinced that banning social media platforms will be an effective solution to the mental health crisis among young people today. So what could work?

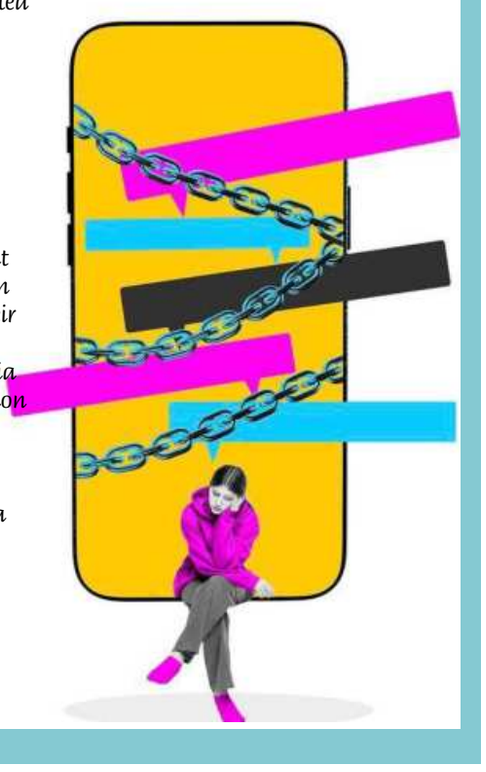
I believe kids' mental health would be better served by governments enforcing safety by default standards on social media platforms rather than outright bans. This means that the highest security and privacy options are in place by default so that minors still on a platform are protected. For instance, accounts would be unsearchable by default, so users would have to intentionally make a profile change to be found by people they don't know in real life. Safety by default standards also place limits on the manipulation, algorithmic restraint and other addictive mechanisms that may lead to psychological harm in vulnerable populations such as young people. Educating kids on digital literacy and online safety as well as ensuring some screen-free time are also going to help support kids' mental health.

It's also important for parents and other caregivers to recognise changes in behaviour as a result of addiction to social platforms and screens. When adults start seeing signs of a problem, they need clear, easy and affordable ways to connect their kids to mental health support, which is not available in most places right now.

And finally, the United Nations recommends bringing kids into the conversation about what's best for them online. Feedback from young people about what they care about, what they get out of being online and what makes it hard for them to look away from their screens could inform changes to social media platforms and education programs that could help young people engage online more safely and maintain a healthy balance.

The writer, Ari Lightman, is from Carnegie Mellon University.

THE CONVERSATION



Youth protests across Europe the overlapping crises facing Gen Z

Although every generation experiences turbulence while navigating adolescence, the pressures experienced by Gen Z are different and seem more pervasive





GenZ protests from around the world. PHOTOS: ANI, REUTERS

Young people are facing a future that feels increasingly uncertain. From climate change and mental health concerns to academic pressure, job and economic insecurity, today's young people are navigating a complex set of expectations. Understanding their frustrations requires looking beyond individual experiences to the social conditions around them.

Adolescence has long been seen as a period of "storm and stress". This reflecting a belief that is a universal and inevitable period of emotional turmoil, behavioural conflict and identity crisis. However, this has been increasingly challenged.

Rather than being defined solely by difficulty and disruption, adolescence is increasingly viewed as a period of possibility, opportunity and growth. Yet realising that potential depends heavily on the social environments in which young people grow up.

There is also increasing recognition that adolescence extends well beyond the teenage years and well into the twenties.

GROWING UP UNDER PRESSURE

Young people nowadays grow up under intense and often overlapping pressure, and today this is to a higher extent than generations before. Evidence from the World Health Organisation's Health Behaviour in School-aged Children study suggests that school-related pressure increased between 2002 and 2022 across many countries. In 2022, among 15-year-old girls, almost two-thirds reported feeling pressured by schoolwork, compared with less than half of boys. The same research documented declines in perceived family and peer support. Parental expectations and criticism have also intensified in many contexts. Success is increasingly framed as an individual responsibility, while educational pathways have become more competitive. At the same time, social media can amplify processes of social comparison, putting young people's achievements, appearance and lifestyles under constant public scrutiny. For many, there is little respite from the pressure to perform.

A warming planet and an uncertain future

Today's young people are growing up amid an increasingly visible climate crisis. They hear repeated warnings about the short- and long-term consequences of climate change. For some, this contributes to feelings of anxiety, worry, sadness, anger and helplessness about environmental degradation and the future. Concerns like this about a genuine global threat can be a rational and entirely understandable response.

What can make these concerns particularly difficult is the perception that the decisions affecting young people's future are often made without their meaningful involvement or consideration of their needs. This cycle of intergenerational injustice needs to be acknowledged and addressed. When people feel they have little influence on issues that will meaningfully shape their lives, this can lead to frustration.

Evidence from many countries suggest that Gen Z are experiencing poorer mental health than previous generations. Public discussions often focus on explanations at an individual level: excessive screen time, reduced resilience and difficulties coping with everyday challenges. While these factors may play a role, they do not account for the whole story.

Mental health is shaped by the interaction between individual experiences and wider social, economic and cultural environments in which people live. It reflects a response to the societal pressures that young people face as they move towards adulthood.

Despite these challenges, it would be wrong to portray Gen Z as a generation defined only by anxiety or pessimism. Protests concerning housing, education, climate policy and economic inequality can express frustration, but they also demonstrate agency and a desire to influence decisions about the future.

The difficulties facing Gen Z are not entirely new. What makes their experience distinctive is the combination of pressures and the uncertainty surrounding the transition to adulthood. Rather than asking whether today's young people have it harder than previous generations, we should ask more productive questions: what kind of society are we asking them to navigate? And what can be done to make it healthier, fairer and more hopeful? THE CONVERSATION

PHOTO: REUTERS





What do you know about Egypt?

1 Who is the current president of Egypt?
2 What is the Great Sphinx made of?
3 Which legendary monumental sculpture with a lion's body and a human head stands guard near the Giza pyramids?
4 What is the capital of Egypt?
5 What was the writing system used in Ancient Egypt called?

Answers on page 3

20-MINUTE ACTIVITY FOR CHILDREN - 1645

GK Corner (3 mins)



This beautiful picture shows colourful trees standing in a park in a residential area in Frankfurt, Germany. Can you spot the yellow-orange leaves among the green ones? Why do some leaves change colour? PHOTO: AP

Ans: As autumn approaches, trees produce less chlorophyll, the pigment responsible for the green colour of leaves. This reveals carotenoids, pigments that were already present in the leaves and produce yellow and orange shades.

Two-minute comprehension

Read the paragraphs below and answer the questions

The central government has notified 15 livestock breeds and one dog breed from various states to help boost breeding programmes and establish sovereignty over these indigenous breeds.

The notified cattle breeds include 'Koppal' from Karnataka; 'Mahakaushali' from Madhya Pradesh; 'Periyar' from Kerala; 'Umarda' from Maharashtra. The only buffalo breed to be notified is 'Gomanchali' from Goa, according to a gazette notification.

Goat species 'Battisi' from Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh, as well as 'Totapuri' from Rajasthan, have been notified by the agriculture ministry.

In the sheep species, 'Asomi' from Assam, 'Kow Debar' from Uttarakhand, 'Madgyal' from Maharashtra and Karnataka, and 'Seemanchali' from Bihar have been notified.

As per the notification, dated October 16, the list includes 'Braj' breed of donkey from Uttar Pradesh, 'Kashmiri' breed of horse from Jammu & Kashmir, 'Nagal' pig breed from Nagaland, 'Sikkimese' breed of yak from Sikkim and 'Kombai' dog breed from Tamil Nadu. The Department of Agricultural Research and Education, under the agriculture ministry, decided that it was necessary and expedient in the public interest to recognise the breeds of livestock and dog.

1) Who has notified 15 livestock breeds and one dog breed?

.....

2) Which all goat species are being talked about in the paragraph?

.....

3) What is the date of the notification?

.....

LIT-WIT IN TWO MINUTES

Identify the false statement

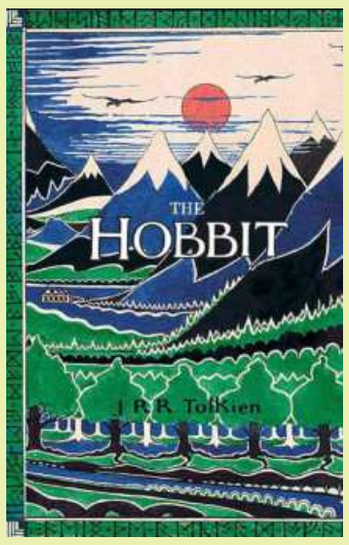


PHOTO: SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

1. The novel *The Book Thief,* is set in Nazi Germany during World War II.

2. The story of *The Hobbit* is the sequel to *The Lord of the Rings.*

3. In the children's book *The Tale of Peter Rabbit,* the protagonist has three sisters.

4. The second book in the Diary of a Wimpy Kid is titled *Rodrick Rules.*

Answer: The story of *The Hobbit* is the prequel to *The Lord of the Rings.*

WORD BUILDER

How many words can you make with the letters in the word

INTERGENERATIONAL

_____ _____
_____ _____
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_____ _____



Unscramble - in a minute

E	G	A	D	E	D	R

The word mean to make people respect somebody less.

Ans: Degrade

AMAZING ANAGRAMS

The following sentences are incomplete. In each, the missing word is the anagram of the highlighted word. See if you can figure it out!

1. "I don't think he should be _____ from the consequences of his betrayal!" My brother **rasped.**

2. The climber maintained a **stance** of confidence and determination during his _____ up the steep mountain.

3. Shanthi **reacts** in shock to the news of the lead actor of her favourite TV series getting _____.

4. The traveller _____ at a hotel after spending hours walking across the **desert.**

An anagram is a word or phrase that is formed by rearranging the letters of another.

Answer: 1. spared, 2. ascent, 3. recast, 4. rested.

Word of the Day

- 2 minutes

QUASH

Pronounced as: kvawsh
Meaning:
To say officially that an earlier decision, is no longer to be accepted (mainly in legal context) or to forcefully stop something that you do not want to happen.
Origin:
The legal term is derived from the Anglo-French words *casser* or *quasser* meaning 'to annul', which trace back to the Latin word *cassus* meaning 'empty'. The second meaning is derived from the Middle English word *quashen* meaning 'to smash', which traces back to the Latin verb *quatere* meaning 'to shake'.
Usage:
Security forces were deployed to quash the protest.
Activity:
Now, use the word in a sentence or two of your own.
.....

Journal Writing

5 minutes

Dear Diary,

One subject I would like to remove from my syllabus would be...

.....
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.....
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MINI QUIZ 2 mins...

Today's quiz is all about stars

1. What is a shooting star actually called?

2. What do we call a group of stars that form a pattern in the sky?

3. What is the closest star to the earth?

4. Which star helps us find the north direction at night?

5. What gas do stars mainly use as fuel?

PHOTO: REUTERS



Answers: 1. Meteor, 2. Constellations, 3. Sun, 4. Polaris, 5. Hydrogen

In how many minutes did you complete today's activities?

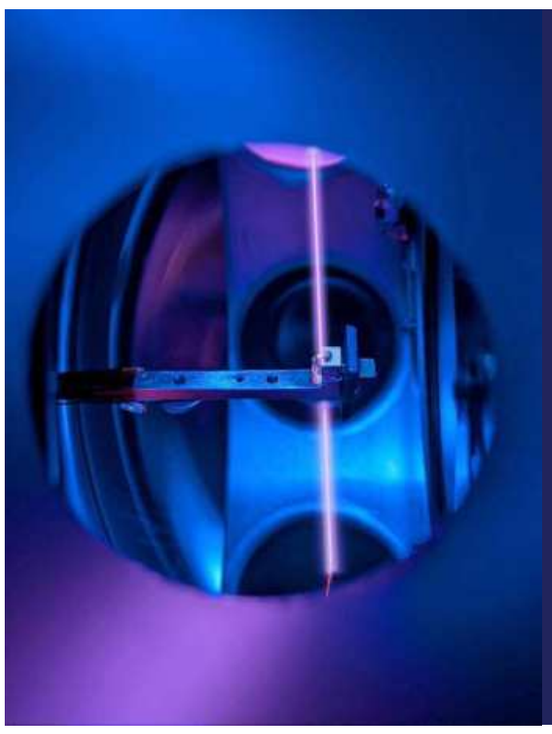


PICTIONARY

Are you someone with a keen eye and great observation? Get ready to challenge yourself...



1 In 1968, the Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel was established by Sweden's central bank, Sveriges Riksbank, to celebrate its 300th anniversary. This year, the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences honoured two scientists for their foundational work on the microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation. Who are these two American scientists who received it this year?



2 These are world's first _____ created by independent scientific teams from Austria and China. The breakthroughs were published in October 2026 by researchers at Austria's TU Wien (Vienna) and China's Tsinghua University (Beijing). While multiple international scientists co-authored these milestones, the host countries driving the two independent historical projects were Austria and China. What was created by the scientists? In picture, a calcium fluoride crystal, in its holder, that incorporates large numbers of thorium nuclei is seen inside the vacuum system of the creation, with a laser beam probing the thorium nuclei, at a laboratory at TU Wien in Vienna, Austria.

3 Para archers Sheetal Devi and Toman Kumar clinched the compound mixed team gold, beating Indonesia's Teodora Audi Ayudia Ferelly and Ken Swagumilang 151-148 in Nagoya on October 22, 2026 at which sporting events?
PHOTO: HANIF SINDHI





4 According to a study published in the journal *Food Chemistry* by researchers at the Leibniz Institute for Food Systems Biology, higher levels of _____ in the atmosphere can significantly alter the production of wheat. The study found that the elevated concentrations of the element can alter the protein composition of the grain. Which element is being talked about here?



5 Animal welfare advocates have long campaigned against horse-drawn carriages due to crowded streets and extreme weather conditions, but the legislative push gained decisive momentum following a tragic accident in Central Park. Which American city set to phase out its historic horse-drawn carriages by June 1, 2028? PHOTOS: REUTERS

6 A popular Public sector bank with 53 crore customers (meaning around every third Indian is an account holder) had informed stock exchanges on October 21, 2026, about a customer data breach. Which is this bank, which is also the largest commercial bank of India? PHOTOS: GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO, AFP



Answers: 1. Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford, 2. Nuclear clocks, 3. Asian Para Games 2026, 4. Carbon dioxide, 5. New York City, 5. State Bank of India (SBI)

MAGIC SQUARE

Fill the empty cells using numbers from 1 to 64 each only once such that

1) Each row, column and two main diagonals of each 4x4 sub square give the magic sum of 130.

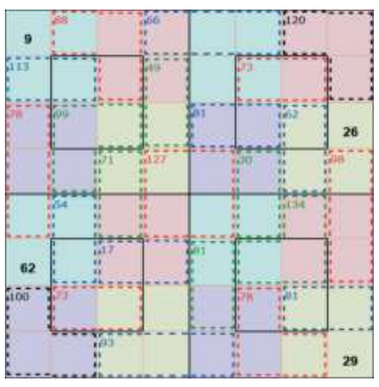
2) Each 2 x 2 square marked in the same colour gives the sum of 130.

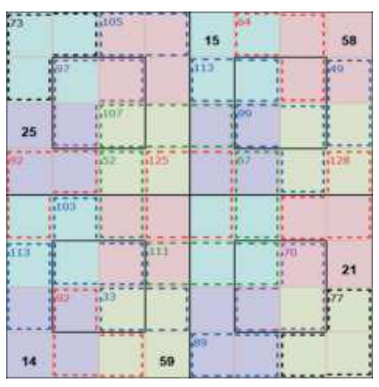
3) The center 2 x 2 marked in black border in each 4x4 sub square give a sum of 130.

4) Group of cells in boxes within dotted lines is a cage.

Cage sum is mentioned at the top in respective colours

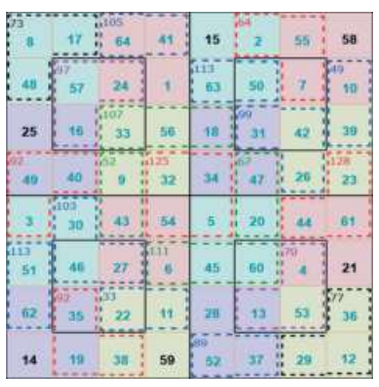
PUZZLES





ANSWERS





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LEARNING TREE

What is biomusicology?

It is the scientific study of music and musicality from a biological perspective.



THE HINDU
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TODAY'S QUIZ: ANSWERS

1. Abdel Fattah el-Sisi
2. Limestone
3. The Great Sphinx of Giza
4. Cairo
5. Hieroglyphs

Published by Nirmala Lakshman and Printed by S. Ramanujam at HT Media Ltd. Plot No. 8, Udyog Vihar, Greater Noida Distt. Gautam Budh Nagar, U.P. 201306, on behalf of THG PUBLISHING PVT LTD., Chennai-600002. Editor: Suresh Nambath Chandrasekar (Responsible for selection of news under the PRP Act).
Regd. DL(ND)-11/6110/2006-07-08 • RNI No. UPENG/2012/49940 • ISSN 0971 - 751X



Prized wild pepper at risk in Madagascar's shrinking forests

A rare wild pepper endemic to Madagascar and prized by international chefs is facing an uncertain future, victim of its own success and the destruction of its forest habitat.



With its subtle, aromatic flavour, Voatsiperifery pepper grows on vines that reach into the canopy of the island's natural forests, which shrank 27% between 1990 and 2025, according to the UN Food and Agriculture Organization. To reach the peppercorns without having to climb, harvesters often tear down the vine and, in many cases, the trees supporting them, contributing to the relentless retreat of Madagascar's forests.



Madagascar pepper sells for 150 to 200 euros (₹15,000 to ₹21,000) per kilogram in France, its main export market.



As research into the Voatsiperifery plant advances, French-Malagasy entrepreneur Olivier Ramaherison has been experimenting with domestic cultivation on land inherited from his father. Between 500 and 1,000 vines – the result of thousands of trials – grew in terraces carved into the Mandraka forest, 60 kilometres east of the capital. There are no support trees here: the plants, laden with fruit just a few weeks from maturity, cluster close to the ground. AFP





"The idea was to try to find a solution to make it easier to pick," said Ramaherison, head of Essentialys, a company that produces aromatic plants, essential oils, coffee and pepper. By chance, his team discovered that cuttings taken from the horizontal branches of the vine no longer tried to climb. "If, like at the Piper nigrum (black pepper) plantations in Vietnam or Brazil, we manage to produce hundreds of tonnes of wild pepper, it would be a real economic boon for the country," he said.

The village of Ambongamarina, northeast of the capital Antananarivo, was at the centre of a rush two decades ago for the pepper, which has a characteristic woody tail, a remnant of its stem. Harvests have dropped as the forest has been consumed by bush fires, charcoal production and slash-and-burn agriculture, or torched in protests against the distant central government. The destruction of the vines has also forced harvesters to go deeper into the forest to find the plant, which in Malagasy is called tsiperifery, meaning "that makes wounds not exist", a reference to its medicinal use for generations.

> "At times, I tell myself I should never have made it known. This pepper blew me away right from the start with that piperine punch that brings out a note of peat, resin, even citrus; it's incomparable. On a fruit salad, it's absolutely delicious.
>
> **Olivier Roellinger**
> FRENCH CHEF WHO FIRST ENCOUNTERED THE SPICE 30 YEARS AGO.

There is no national system to track the distribution, harvesting and export of this precious pepper, said Mima Chateauneuf, co-founder of bulk export company Jacarandas. In the absence of a regulatory framework, Jacarandas is turning towards organic pepper, which has grown to make up one-third of its exports. "For organic products, traceability is mandatory," Chateauneuf said.. REPORT/PHOTO: AFP

CRACK IT!

Samples from competitive exams

Sometimes questions that seem complex, actually need just logic and common sense. Can you solve this question which appeared in UPSC CISF exam, 2026?



Question

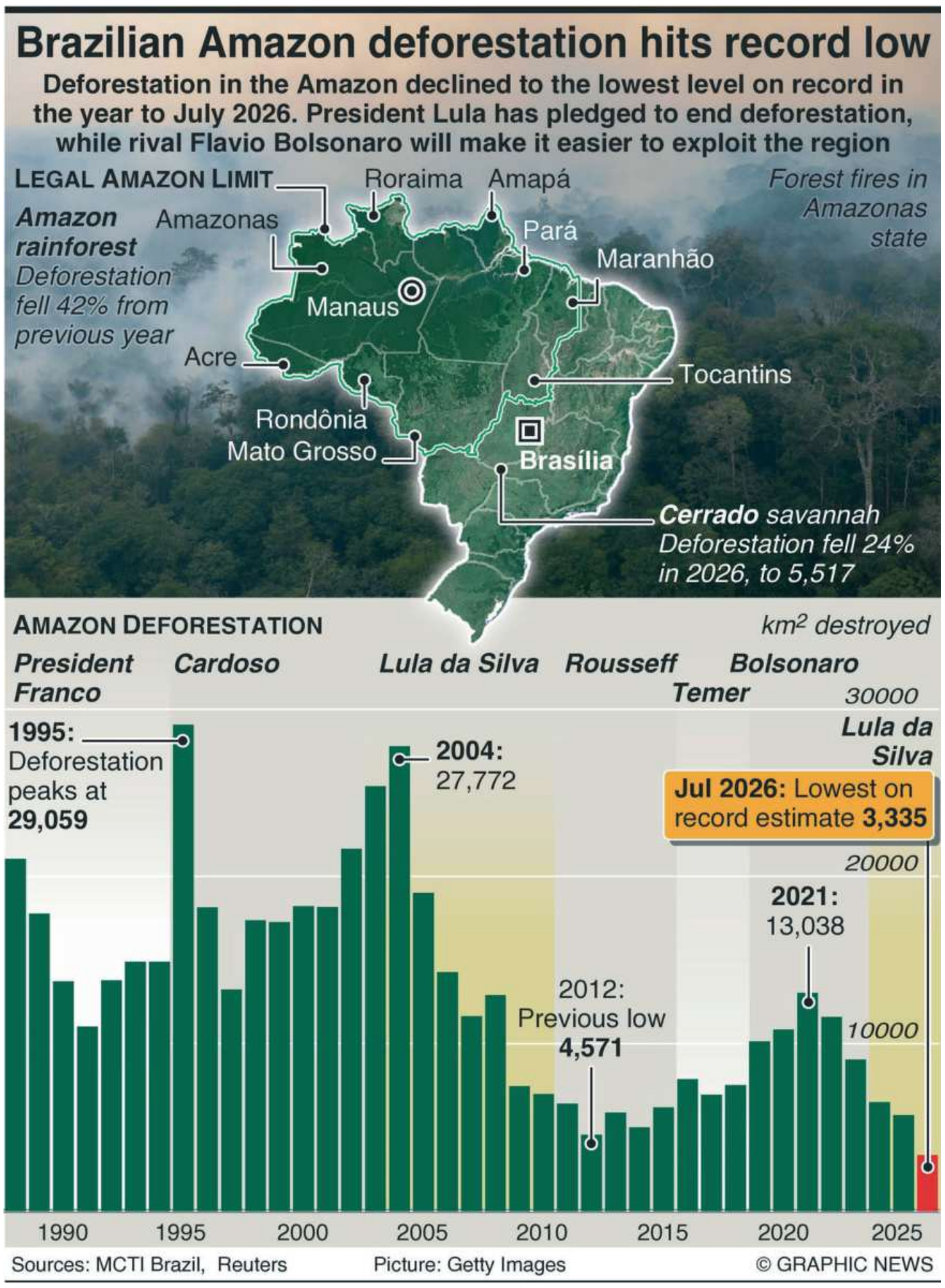
Ten identical silver coins are melted to make new coins having half the thickness and one-third the diameter of the original coins. What is the total number of new coins made ?

(a) 60
(b) 90
(c) 120
(d) 180

Answer:

1. Let the original coin have radius r and thickness t.
2. Volume of one original coin = pi × r × r × t. (pi×r²×t
3. The new coin has radius = r divided by 3 and thickness = t divided by 2
4. Volume of one new coin: pi × (r/3) × (r/3) × (t/2) = pi × r²/9 × t/2 = (1/18) × pi × r² × t
5. So, each new coin uses one-eighteenth of the volume of one original coin.
6. Total silver is from 10 original coins: 10 × 18 = 180

Answer: (d) 180 new coins



QWIKIPEDIA: A DAILY SEARCH-AND-LEARN ACTIVITY

Ever been on Wikipedia to search for something? More often than not we start with one topic, click a few links and within no time, are eagerly reading something else. Qwikipedia is a game that tries to quench our curiosity to learn something new. Start with one search from a specific article in this newspaper, and get started on a journey of learning with multiple clicks. Surprise yourself by finding new routes each time!

THE SATURDAY SAUNTER: THE FOG WARNING → WAFFLES



THE FOG WARNING

Considered one of Winslow Homer's best works, The Fog Warning depicts a fisherman in a dory boat with his catch of the day, trying to row back to his ship while fog threatens his trip back. The 19th Century American painter used to initially paint themes connected to the Civil War and then moved on to painting themes like children playing, people relaxing, farm life and sea scenes. During the 1980s, he started painting local fishing communities. After returning to the United States, he started painting the sea with more serious themes, such as the hard and dangerous lives of the fishermen and their families, depicted in paintings like 'The Fog Warning' while visiting and staying in **Maine.**

MAINE

A state in the New England region of the United States, Maine is known for its jagged, rocky Atlantic Ocean and bay-shore coastlines, mountains, heavily forested interior, and its cuisine, particularly wild lowbush blueberries and seafood such as lobster and clams. Coastal and Down East Maine have emerged as important centres for the creative economy. The state is also known to be a significant U.S. producer of blueberries and **maple syrup.**





MAPLE SYRUP

Made from the sap of maple trees, maple syrup is a sweet syrup used as a dip or even filling for multiple dishes. In cold climates, maple trees store starch in their trunks and roots before winter. This starch is then converted to sugar that rises in the sap in late winter and early spring. Maple trees are then tapped by drilling holes into their trunks to collect the sap, which is heated to evaporate much of the water, leaving the concentrated syrup. Maple syrup is popularly used with pancakes and **waffles.**

WAFFLES

A waffle is a dish made from usually leavened batter or dough that is cooked between two plates that are usually checkered-patterned. Ancient Greek cooks back in the day pressed flat, savoury cakes called obelios (or a bellio) between two hot metal plates over an open fire. This is often believed to be the origin of the idea of waffles. Europe then saw the creation of wafers, which later evolved into waffles, a thicker and fluffier version of wafers. The modern waffle is believed to have originated in Belgium. Today, waffles are eaten throughout the world and have over a dozen regional varieties based on the type of waffle iron and recipe used.



PHOTOS: WIKIMEDIA COMMONS, AP, UNSPLASH

So, the path we have travelled today is The Fog Warning → Maine → Maple Syrup → Waffles
Three clicks! Hop over!
Send in your paths for the above to school@thehindu.co.in with the subject: Qwikipedia

IN SCHOOL INBOX

Showcase your creativity

A couple of artivity entries sent in by students

ARTIVITY

Read the newspaper and create an original artwork based on a news item that interests you and send your entry in JPEG format (not as PDF) to school@thehindu.co.in with the subject - Artivity. ONLY artworks based on current news or issues relating to Science, Space, Environment, Wildlife and Sports will be considered for publication. Please AVOID mailing other works. Mention your name, class, school and city in the same mail (not in separate mails).



V.K. Sabarish
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Maharishi Vidhya Mandir,
Mangadu, Chennai, Tamil Nadu



Jessitha
Class XI
Arumugam Academy
Aravakurichy
Karur, Tamil Nadu

BLOWIN' IN THE WIND



Tourists wearing Korean traditional costume Hanbok react as they make their way through strong winds at Gyeongbok palace in Seoul, South Korea. PHOTO: REUTERS

GUESS WHO?



This Indian actor, film director, producer, television presenter, and politician is the recipient of several accolades, including five National Film Awards and eight Tamil Nadu State Film Awards. Born in 1965, he is known for his movies in Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Hindi and English-language films.

Ans: Prakash Raj (born Prakash Rai)

SUDOKU

	8	6					5	
7		3		5		1		9
					2			8
		9		2				6
		2	6		5	9		
5				1		8		
3			9					
9		4		7		6		1
	5					7	9	

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DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★☆☆

A mind game and a puzzle that you solve with reasoning and logic. Fill in the grid with digits in such a manner that every row, every column and every 3x3 box accommodates the digits 1 to 9, without repeating any. The solution to today's puzzle is at right.

2	8	6	1	9	3	4	5	7
7	4	3	8	5	6	1	2	9
1	9	5	7	4	2	3	6	8
8	3	9	4	2	7	5	1	6
4	1	2	6	8	5	9	7	3
5	6	7	3	1	9	8	4	2
3	7	1	9	6	4	2	8	5
9	2	4	5	7	8	6	3	1
6	5	8	2	3	1	7	9	4

MotoGP riders prepare for 'emotional' farewell to Phillip Island

The picturesque and often windswept track, some two hours outside of Melbourne, has been a staple on the calendar since 1997



PHILLIP ISLAND, AUSTRALIA:
Seven-time world champion Marc Marquez admits it will be "emotional" this weekend as one of MotoGP's most iconic circuits at Phillip Island hosts its last race after nearly three decades.

The picturesque and often windswept track, some two hours outside of Melbourne, has been a staple on the calendar since 1997 and a favourite among the riders given its waterfront location and demanding layout. But its contract expires this year.

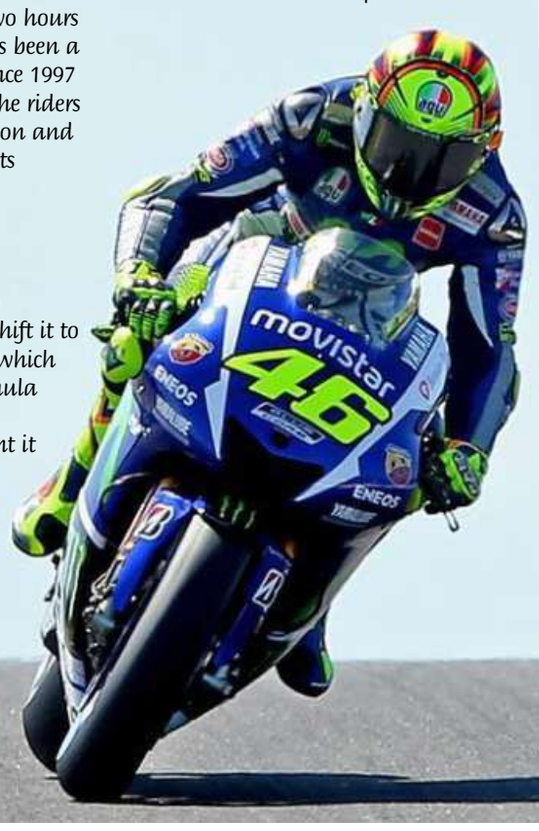
Broadening horizons

Promoter MotoGP Sports Entertainment wanted to broaden its appeal and shift it to Melbourne's Albert Park, which hosts the Australian Formula One. The Victorian state government was adamant it should remain at Phillip Island. With negotiations breaking down, South Australia stepped in and secured the race for six years from 2027 in Adelaide — the first MotoGP to be held in a city centre location.

"Phillip Island is an extraordinary circuit. Racing here for the last time will be emotional," said Ducati's Marquez, who heads into the weekend two points behind Aprilia's Jorge Martin in the championship standings. "It is a track with a unique, breathtaking layout. Here I won one of my first races with Ducati and we are motivated to do well, ready to fight right away for the positions that matter." The venue has seen some of the Spaniard's most impressive rides and also some of his worst moments including a huge high-speed crash with Johann Zarco in 2018.



"It will be the last time on this track, a circuit where I haven't managed to win yet, but which holds an incredible charm, an extraordinary layout, and pure adrenaline.
Francesco "Pecco" Bagnaia
MOTOGP RIDER FOR DUCATI LENOVO TEAM



A view of the Phillip Island circuit. PHOTOS: REUTERS. AFP



Teammate Francesco Bagnaia has never stood on the top step of the Phillip Island podium.

But the 2022 and 2023 races, where he finished third and second respectively, were vitally important to his title-winning exploits and he too is sad to see it go. With five rounds to go, the title fight has effectively become a three-way battle between Martin, reigning champion Marquez and Marco Bezzecchi, who won the last race in Indonesia to stay in touch.

Aprilia's Bezzecchi is 44 points behind Marquez and 50 clear of fourth-placed Ai Ogura.

"We arrive in Australia with the gaps in the riders' standings even tighter, so we have to keep working and keep faith in what everyone at Aprilia and the team is doing," said Martin. "I'm confident that my team and I will do an excellent job and give this circuit the send-off it deserves."

One last round

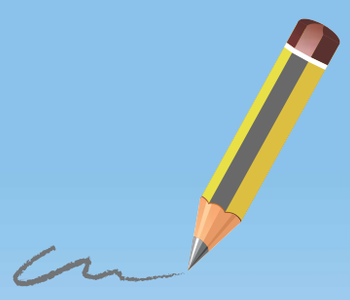
Marquez and Martin both missed last year's Australian race with injuries, and Spain's Raul Fernandez grabbed his chance to surge to a maiden MotoGP victory.

Currently seventh in the standings, Fernandez is equally dismayed at the race leaving Phillip Island. "I will cry a little bit," he said. "Not because I got my first MotoGP victory here but also because I always enjoy it a lot coming to Phillip Island — it is super nice. There were so many interesting races in the past here, not just in MotoGP, also in Moto2 and Moto3, so it's a track that everybody will miss a little bit." AFP

HAVE YOU READ TODAY'S IN SCHOOL ?

Here's how you can engage yourself in the learning process with the newspaper. Maintain a book and write down the activities date-wise. Besides honing your language skills, it will also help you sharpen your critical thinking and relate better to the world around you.

THE THREE WORDS I LEARNT TODAY



Words	Meanings
1).....	.....
2).....	.....
3).....	.....

BACKGROUND CHECK

Select an article that interests you, do some research on the subject and write down three interesting points on the subject.

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PICK A PICTURE, TELL THE STORY....

Go through the newspaper, select one picture, and write five lines about it.



Picture / Page number

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LEARNING CURVE

Two facts that I learned from today's newspaper.

1

2



MY GRAMMAR PINS

Read the newspaper and answer the following.

NOUNS & VERBS
Pick five words and tick them as nouns or verbs.

noun/ verb

noun/ verb

noun/ verb

noun/ verb

noun/ verb

MY DAILY 8 TO 8 PLANNER



Use this chart to plan your day.





.....

.....

MY MOOD BOARD

Draw an emoji to express how you feel today.Get as creative as possible.





PAST, PRESENT, FUTURE

Pick two words each in the Past, Present and Future tenses.

